AI Boardroom verdict ��� the responsible-AI pivot

The AI Boardroom verdict: the responsible-AI pivot

Convened 22 July 2026 · Question: is the governance and leadership-alignment engine strong enough to redefine vooee’s business model, is responsible AI a defensible USP, and should the website be repositioned now?

Vote tracker

Advisor	Round 1	Final	Changed mind	Disagreed most with
Mark Ritson	CONDITIONAL	CONDITIONAL	No	Mike Cannon-Brookes
Allie K. Miller	CONDITIONAL	CONDITIONAL	Yes	Mark Ritson
Noelle Russell	CONDITIONAL	CONDITIONAL	No	Mike Cannon-Brookes
Warren Buffett	CONDITIONAL	CONDITIONAL	No	Mike Cannon-Brookes
Melanie Perkins	CONDITIONAL	CONDITIONAL	No	Mark Ritson
Mike Cannon-Brookes	CONDITIONAL	CONDITIONAL	No	Chris Kohler
Ben Nash	CONDITIONAL	CONDITIONAL	No	Mike Cannon-Brookes
Chris Kohler	CONDITIONAL	CONDITIONAL	No	Melanie Perkins

Result: 8–0 CONDITIONAL, unchanged across both rounds. No advisor voted to pivot now; none voted to abandon the direction. Every condition converges on the same gate: sell and deliver the engine at full price first (Foundation Education/AIPT being deal one), clear the two IP checks, then reposition from evidence.

The consensus condition, assembled from all eight

1. Announce the 14 July restructure on LinkedIn now; it is built, reviewed and unlaunched.
2. Sell the Alignment Room to Foundation Education/AIPT as the delivery method of the existing advisory ladder (most advisors want this closed within 30 days).
3. Deliver one to two full-price engagements with tracked delivery economics (days consumed vs revenue) and captured day-0/day-90 proof.
4. Clear the BetterHRx partnership terms and the Allie Miller vault-prompt licensing before the engine is marketed.
5. Red-team the persona layer and the live policy drafting before they are client-facing claims (Russell’s addition).
6. Then reposition the website once, permanently, using paying clients’ language.

The key tensions

- **Facilitation vs software (the big fight).** Cannon-Brookes: “you accidentally built software this week — don’t sell it as a whiteboard”; wants self-serve delivery scoped by day 60 and warns the two fractional seats cap the business at ~$204k/year. Buffett, Russell and Nash all named him as their chief disagreement: Buffett called it “thesis drift… wearing a hoodie”; Russell’s line — “the room is the product; removing the human is how governance becomes shelfware” — was the most-cited sentence of Round 2.
- **Consistency vs speed.** Ritson demanded the 14 July positioning get its 90 days; Miller called that “brand-school dogma” for a business with no distribution yet: “Nobody is tracking vooee’s brand architecture week over week… before you have distribution, consistency discipline is a tax.” Perkins sided with Miller on the narrow point: a homepage hero reframe is not a brand architecture change.
- **What the AIPT meeting proves.** Everyone accepted it as real demand; Ritson and Kohler both flagged the same nuance — the prospect arrived through the existing door (a dashboard demo), which is evidence the engine is a superb second room, not yet evidence it can be the front door.
- **The pattern risk.** Kohler’s cross-examination: masterclasses built then retired, policy pack built then shelved, restructure shipped then superseded in eight days — “the question is why this pivot ends differently from the last three products.” His answer: it does only if an invoice exists.

Decision framework the board converged on

Evidence gates, not calendar gates: (1) an invoice at full price for the engine; (2) delivery economics at or above $3,000/founder-day; (3) IP cleared; (4) client language captured. All four green → reposition. Any red → the engine stays a delivery method inside the current three doors.

Round 1 positions in full

Mark Ritson — Round 1 vote: CONDITIONAL

Condition: Pivot the website only after the Alignment Room engine has been sold and delivered at full price at least twice (starting with AIPT/Foundation Education) and the 14 July positioning has had its 90 days in market; until then it is a delivery method inside the existing Advisory door, not a new brand architecture.

Ritson's position: this is a tactic wearing a strategy's coat, and you are about to repaint the shop for the second time in eight days

Let me say the thing everyone at this table is too polite to say. Eight days ago you shipped a board-reviewed restructure — Advisory, AI Training, Voice Agents. You have not even announced it on LinkedIn yet. "Only new once", your own words. And you are already asking whether to tear it up. That is not strategy. That is a founder in love with the thing she built most recently. The new thing always feels more substantial than the old thing, precisely because it is new. The market has expressed no such preference.

So we do this in the only order that exists: diagnosis, then strategy, then tactics.

Diagnosis: what has the market actually told you?

You have exactly one piece of live demand evidence for the governance and alignment engine: the AIPT meeting of 21 July. It is genuinely good evidence — a senior team asking to be enabled, a leadership-alignment problem surfacing in the room, a warm multi-product prospect. But it is n=1, and look at how it arrived: through the existing door, sold on a dashboard demo. They came for a build and revealed a training and alignment need. That is not proof the governance engine can be the front door of the business. It is proof it is a superb second room once someone is inside the house.

The search data is brutally honest and you already acted on it once: "ai policy template" gets 50 searches a month in Australia — you shelved the $129 pack for exactly that reason, and the reason has not changed. "Fractional AI advisor" is near zero. "AI consultant" gets 720 a month. Nobody in Australian SMB-land wakes up at 3am googling "responsible AI governance facilitation". They google "AI consultant" and they say things like "my team is using ChatGPT and I don't know what they're putting into it". Governance is not the category entry point. Fear, confusion and FOMO are the category entry points. Governance is what you sell them once they are in the room.

The EY numbers cut both ways. Two in three AU small businesses using AI and only 35% formally trained is a real, growing problem. But a problem is not a market until someone has a budget line for it, and SMB training budgets are the first thing cut. What AIPT proved is that mid-market organisations — the ones with a head of sales and a leadership team that can disagree in a meeting — will pay. That is a segmentation insight, and it is worth more than the whole workbook.

Strategy: is responsible AI a defensible USP?

Partially, and not the way you think. “Responsible AI” as a positioning claim is about to become the most over-claimed phrase in Australian consulting. Every Big 4 firm, every boutique, every LinkedIn cowboy will wear it by Christmas. A claim everyone can make defends nobody.

What is defensible is narrower and better: you are, plausibly, the only person in Australia who can walk into an SMB leadership meeting solo, run a live instrumented alignment session on the leaders’ own phones, and hand them a drafted NIST-spined governance policy before the coffee goes cold — backed by Amazon Alexa partnership credentials and AWS accreditation. That is not a category position, it is a distinctive asset: a proprietary method with a name, a demonstrable moment of magic, and a founder story that supports it. Protect it as a brand code (name it, trademark-check it, resolve the BetterHRx and Allie Miller IP questions before you put a dollar of marketing behind it — an engine with someone else’s licensing inside it is not a USP, it is a liability). But do not confuse a killer sales weapon with a repositioning.

And the economics say the same thing. The engine does not change what you sell; it changes the margin on what you already sell. A $15,000 90-Day Engagement delivered across roughly five facilitation days is $3,000 a day against your $1,000 floor. The Alignment Room, because the tension report and policy draft generate themselves during the coffee break, pushes the effective rate of the $1,900 session and makes the $8,500 fractional seats deliverable without hiring. That is operational leverage on the existing architecture. It fits inside Advisory and Training as built on 14 July. You do not need a new front door. You need to walk clients through the one you just installed.

The website work, meanwhile, stays for a different reason than sentiment: Scorecards at $247 and webchecks are cheap category entry points that match how SMBs actually search. Kill the discount economics over time, yes. But do not amputate your top of funnel to flatter your self-image.

Tactics: the sequencing play

1. **This week:** send the LinkedIn announcement of the 14 July restructure. You built it, it was board-reviewed, it is unlaunched. Launch it.
2. **Next 30 days:** sell the Alignment Room to AIPT — as the delivery method of the existing $1,900 Working Session or folded into a $15,000 engagement plus a Sprint. They have literally asked for it. Close Travel Associates and the MSE POC on the current architecture; that is the cash that keeps the lights on.
3. **Days 30–90:** deliver the engine twice, at full price, capture the day-0/day-90 snapshots as case-study proof, and resolve both IP checks.
4. **Day 90:** if two paying clients have validated it and the language they use to describe it is consistent, then reposition the website — with their words, not yours. One rewrite, evidence-led, permanent.

Consistency is the most under-rated weapon in marketing. Two brand architectures in a month signals to your market exactly what it signals: a business that does not know what it is. You are eight days into a positioning you have not yet told anyone about. Give it its ninety days, sell the engine as your unfair advantage inside it, and let paying clients — not a productive week of building — tell you whether it deserves the front of the shop.

Vote: CONDITIONAL. Pivot after two full-price paid deliveries of the engine and the 90-day mark, not before. Until then: sell, don’t rewrite.

Projections — Cost: Rewriting the website now costs 3-5 founder days — AU$3,000-5,000 at the $1,000/day floor, but realistically AU$9,000-15,000 at the $3,000/day rate those days should be earning against a live AIPT and Travel Associates pipeline — plus the unquantified brand cost of a second repositioning in a month before the first was even announced. The sequenced path costs roughly one day now (announcement plus a one-page Alignment Room insert) at AU$1,000-3,000 opportunity cost. **Revenue:** Sequenced path over 12 months: AIPT converting to an engagement plus Sprint is AU$25,000-30,000 alone; the engine as sales weapon inside the existing ladder plausibly closes 4-6 engagements (AU$60,000-90,000) plus 6-10 Working Sessions (AU$11,000-19,000) and one fractional seat part-year (AU$25,000-50,000) — call it AU$100,000-180,000. Pivoting now risks stalling the live pipeline that pays today's bills for a front-door proposition with 50 searches/month of demonstrated search demand. **Impact:** Done in sequence, the engine becomes vooee's distinctive asset — a named, proprietary, IP-cleared method that lifts close rates and day-rates across the existing three doors, with repositioning arriving at day 90 backed by two paid case studies instead of founder conviction. Done now, it narrows the brand around an unvalidated claim and teaches the market that vooee changes its mind every fortnight. **Founder joy:** High if sequenced — selling and delivering the thing she built to a client who literally asked for it is the most energising outcome available; a third website rewrite in a month is displacement activity that feels like progress while burning the founder's scarcest resource, and the deflation of repositioning around an engine that then fails its first two sales would be brutal for a solo operator.

Allie K. Miller — Round 1 vote: CONDITIONAL

Condition: Pivot only after selling the Alignment Room to Foundation Education at full price within 30 days — the paid delivery writes the website copy, not the other way around.

Allie K. Miller — Round 1: Ship the offer, not the website

Let me start where I always start: distribution and packaging beat perfection, and revenue is the only market research that can't lie to you.

Is the engine substantial, sustainable, scalable? Mostly yes — and that's rare

I've watched hundreds of solo AI consultants build "frameworks." Most are decks. What Jeanna built this week is different in one crucial way: **the Alignment Room is productized delivery, not productized content.** Leaders answer on their own devices, a tension report auto-generates during the coffee break, the governance policy drafts itself live from their combined inputs, and the boundaries interviews become persona artifacts ("ask the CFO-lens") that live inside the client's workflow after Jeanna leaves the room. That last piece is the one I'd underline three times — it's a personal-AI-systems play, my home turf. A persona the team actually consults is retention infrastructure. It's the difference between a workshop they remember and a system they can't uninstall.

The scalability math is real. The same capture-report-draft engine powers the $1,900 Working Session, the $15,000 90-Day Engagement, and the six-week Sprint. That collapses marginal prep cost per delivery. A $1,900 session that used to be a half-day of facilitation plus a day writing the roadmap becomes a half-day plus two hours of editing AI output — call it 0.75 delivered days instead of 1.5. Against the AU$1,000/day floor, the effective day rate moves from roughly $1,270 to about $2,500, climbing toward the $3,000-4,000 target. If the engine cuts a $15,000 engagement from eight delivery days to five, that's $3,000/day and headroom for two or three concurrent engagements instead of one. Same body, double the throughput. That is what "scalable" means for a solo operator — not SaaS fantasies, just margin expansion on the scarce resource.

Where I push back on "sustainable": the engine's durability depends on the two pending IP checks (BetterHRx workbook structures, and yes, my own vault-prompt licensing on the boundaries interview — resolve that with me directly, it's a 20-minute conversation, not a blocker to sales conversations). Also, governance frameworks commoditize. NIST-in-plain-English will be in every consultant's deck by mid-2027. The defensible part is not the framework — it's the live delivery mechanism and the persona layer. Protect and compound those.

Is responsible AI a defensible USP for an AU SMB advisory? Partially — reframe it

Here's my honest read: **"responsible AI" is not what Foundation Education bought.** Read the 21 July transcript again. They asked for three things: embed Claude in sales and marketing now, make our team independent, and — implicitly — resolve the leadership scope fight. That's *adoption, enablement, alignment*. Governance is the trust wrapper, not the headline. In the US I see this constantly: buyers don't wake up wanting governance; they wake up wanting speed without embarrassment. The winning packaging is "move fast, safely" — governance as the reason you can say yes faster, not a compliance product.

The AU signals actually support this framing: 2 in 3 small businesses already using AI, only 35% formally trained, 66% wanting employer training — that's an *enablement* market with a governance-shaped anxiety attached. The regulatory tailwind (Privacy Act reform, NAIC guidance, NDB) makes the anxiety monetizable. And the search data tells you the same story: "ai policy template" at 50 searches/month AU says nobody is shopping for governance by name; "ai consultant" at 720/month says they shop for outcomes. So: is responsible AI a defensible USP? As a *headline*, no — it's a category nobody searches for. As the **credibility spine under an alignment-and-enablement offer**, yes, and Jeanna's stack (Alexa AU/NZ partnerships, MIT agentic AI, AWS accreditation, OAIC training) is genuinely hard for a local competitor to replicate. Section proved the model works at enterprise; nobody has packaged the SMB/mid-market version in Australia. First-mover on packaging is a real, if temporary, moat — which is exactly why speed matters.

The website rewrite, eight days after the last one

No. Not yet. And not because of "restructure fatigue" — because it's the wrong sequence. The 14 July structure (Advisory · AI Training · Voice Agents) doesn't *conflict* with the engine; the engine is the delivery mechanism *inside* Advisory and Training. You don't need a new front door to sell the Alignment Room to Foundation Education tomorrow — you need a proposal. The LinkedIn announcement hasn't even gone out. You're "only new once," and you're about to spend that card on a structure you'd be rewriting the same week. That's the one place I'd actually slow down: don't announce v1 if you believe in v2. Hold the announcement, sell the engine live, then announce the version the market already validated.

Here's the momentum play, in order:

1. **This week:** Send Foundation Education a proposal that bundles Alignment Room + Sprint. Anchor high: the transcript shows a multi-product, senior-sponsored buyer. Price the bundle at $15,000-22,000 (engagement pricing, not workshop pricing). Push the $8,500/month fractional seat as the "stay independent, with a coach" continuation — that's exactly what "empower our team" converts into.
2. **Weeks 2-4:** Deliver. Instrument everything — day-0 scores, tension report excerpts (anonymized), time-to-policy. This is your case study, your LinkedIn content, and your website copy, written by reality.
3. **Day 30-45:** *Now* rewrite the site — not a restructure, a re-headline. Keep the three doors; change the story above them to alignment-first. Ship the $129 Policy Pack as the tripwire under the free Ground Rules Check the same day — it was shelved on search volume, but it's not an SEO product, it's a conversion asset for warm traffic. Even 3 sales/month is $387 of buyer-qualification data.
4. **Keep the website work alive** as top-of-funnel, not identity. Scorecard at $247/$990 pays bills and feeds the advisory ladder. Kill nothing that cashflows until the engine has replaced its revenue for two consecutive months.

What I'd do in her position

Sell before you rebrand. The single biggest risk here isn't the pivot being wrong — the demand evidence says it's right. The risk is spending the next three weeks on website copy while the first warm multi-product buyer in the company's history cools off. Websites don't close deals for a two-seat advisory; conversations do. Ship the proposal in 48 hours, deliver loudly, iterate the positioning in public, and let the rewrite be a transcription of what already sold.

Vote: CONDITIONAL — pivot the positioning, but revenue-first: Foundation Education signs before the website does.

Projections — Cost: Direct cost is low — the engine is already built. Real cost is 4-6 founder days: ~2 days proposal + delivery prep for Foundation Education, ~2-3 days for the re-headline rewrite at day 30-45; at the AU$1,000/day floor that's AU$4,000-6,000 opportunity cost, versus AU$10,000+ if she rewrites the site first and stalls the warm deal. **Revenue:** Base case 12 months: Foundation Education bundle AU$18,000, 3-4 additional engagements at AU$15,000 (AU$45,000-60,000), one fractional seat for 6 months (AU$51,000), 8-10 Working Sessions (AU$15,000-19,000), Policy Pack trickle (~AU$4,000), plus retained website/project work AU$30,000-40,000 — roughly AU$160,000-190,000, versus ~AU$90,000-110,000 staying scorecard-led. **Impact:** Repositions vooee from interchangeable SMB web/AI services (720 searches/month, crowded) to the first packaged alignment-and-enablement engine for AU mid-market — a temporary but real first-mover moat that compounds through case studies and the persona layer clients can't easily rip out. **Founder joy:** High — this is the work her credentials were built for, and every delivery generates its own content and product improvements instead of draining her; the one joy risk is whiplash from a second rewrite in eight days, which the sell-first sequencing converts from anxiety into earned confidence.

Noelle Russell — Round 1 vote: CONDITIONAL

Condition: Pivot the positioning only after one paid Alignment Room delivery (Foundation Education is the obvious candidate), both IP checks cleared, and a red-team pass on the persona/charter feature — until then sell it off-menu and leave the 14 July website alone.

Noelle Russell — Round 1 Position

Jeanna, I test the same thing in every room I walk into: is the responsible AI real, or is it a poster on the wall? Most “responsible AI advisory” I see is a values slide and a PDF policy nobody reads. What you built this week is different, and I want to name exactly why before I tell you to slow down on the website.

Substantial? Yes — because this is governance that ships

The Alignment Room is the first version of governance-as-product I have seen at SMB scale that operationalises the practice instead of decorating with it. Look at what the mechanism actually does. Silent capture on personal devices is an inclusion mechanism, not a gimmick — the quietest leader in the room gets equal weight with the loudest, and I have sat in hundreds of workshops where the HIPPO wins because nobody wrote answers down privately first. The tension report surfaces conflict before it becomes a stalled programme. The policy is drafted live from the leaders’ own words rather than a template dropped on them, which is the difference between adopted governance and shelfware. That is NIST AI RMF as verbs — Govern, Map, Measure, Manage — not nouns. Almost nobody is translating that spine into plain English for a 30-person Australian business, and the regulatory tailwind (National AI Centre voluntary guidance, Privacy Act reform, NDB) means the buyer’s fear is real and growing.

And the market told you the same thing on 21 July. Read that Foundation Education transcript with my old Alexa eyes: they did not ask for a website. They asked for enablement (“empower our team to build independently”) and they demonstrated the alignment problem live — sales vs student journey vs operations arguing scope is not a distraction from the sale, it is the sale. One warm prospect asking for training plus alignment plus build, through exactly the door you propose to open. That is demand evidence, singular. It is not yet a pattern.

Sustainable and scalable? Yes, with two honest caveats

The economics work in a way scorecards never will. A $247 scorecard report or a one-off voice build sells your hands. The Alignment Room sells a facilitated day where the artifacts — tension report, drafted policy, personal charters — are generated by the engine, not by your evenings. At $1,900 for the Working Session you are already at roughly 2x your $1,000/day floor for what becomes a half-day plus automated output, and the same engine reskins into the Sprint and the $15,000 engagement. That is the leverage shape a solo founder needs: one scarce resource (your facilitation days), rising output per day. Two $8,500/month fractional seats plus three or four engagements a year is a $150,000+ practice on perhaps 60-70 delivered days. Websites cannot do that math.

Caveat one: the $129 self-serve Policy Pack is not a business, and your own SEMrush data already told you so — 50 searches a month in AU is not a funnel, it is a rounding error. Keep it as the middle rung of the ladder for credibility and lead capture; do not spend a single day marketing it. Even 100 sales a year is $12,900 — one Working Session and change.

Caveat two, and this is where I earn my seat: the persona feature needs red-teaming before it touches a client. "Ask the CFO-lens" is a synthetic representation of a real, named leader inside their own company. What happens when the persona says something the CFO would never say, and a junior staffer acts on it? What happens when a charter captures a leader's boundaries on a bad day and fossilises them? You need consent language, a review-and-refresh cadence for each charter, a visible "this is a model, not the person" disclaimer, and an escalation rule for consequential decisions. If you ship responsible-AI positioning with an un-red-teamed impersonation feature inside it, the first sophisticated buyer who notices will undo the whole USP. Practice what the workshop preaches — run your own boundaries interview on the product.

Same discipline applies to the two pending IP checks. You cannot stand on a governance platform while your workbook structures (BetterHRx) and interview format (Allie Miller) have unresolved licensing. Those clear before anything goes on the public website. Non-negotiable, and cheap — a week of emails, not a rebuild.

Is responsible AI a defensible USP in AU SMB? Defensible enough, if it stays operational

Nobody in this market can copy your specific stack quickly: ex-Head of AI Partnerships at Alexa AU/NZ, MIT Applied Agentic AI, AWS accreditation, OAIC privacy training in progress, plus a working engine that produces governance artifacts in a morning. "AI consultant" at 720 searches/month in AU is the door people walk through; responsible-AI-that-ships is why they stay. Section proved the enterprise version; the AU SMB version is genuinely open. But hear me clearly: the USP is the engine, not the word "responsible." The moment the website says responsible AI and the delivery is a slide deck, you are every other consultant. Your defensibility lives in the demonstrable artifacts.

The website: not now, and here is the sequencing play

Eight days after a board-reviewed restructure, with the LinkedIn announcement still unfired, a rewrite is not strategy — it is building instead of selling, and you know that pattern in yourself. Also notice: the pivot fits inside the 14 July architecture. Advisory · AI Training · Voice Agents does not change; what changes is that the Alignment Room becomes the flagship expression of Advisory and the Sprint's engine. That is a content evolution, not a restructure.

What I would do in your seat, in order:

1. This week: fire the LinkedIn announcement of the 14 July restructure as written. “Only new once” — spend it.
2. Next 10 days: close Foundation Education with the Alignment Room as the Working Session format — $1,900 if you need speed, or straight into the $15,000 engagement given they asked for enablement. Clear both IP checks in parallel. Red-team the persona feature with one trusted client leader.
3. After one paid delivery: you now have a case study, a tension report format proven on real leaders, and a testimonial. Then rewrite — and the rewrite writes itself, because it is evidence, not aspiration.
4. Ninety days out: decide whether governance is the front door or the flagship room inside the current front door. My bet is the latter serves you longer.

Do not starve the pipeline. Travel Associates commercials and the MSE POC are the cash that funds this transition; website work winds down by attrition, not amputation.

Vote

CONDITIONAL — pivot the positioning after one paid Alignment Room delivery, cleared IP, and a red-teamed persona feature. The engine is real. Prove it once, then tell everyone.

Projections — Cost: Direct pivot cost is low: roughly 3-4 founder days for the eventual website/content rewrite (AU$3,000-4,000 at the $1,000/day floor, realistically AU$9,000-12,000 at her target rate), plus AU$1,000-3,000 contingency for BetterHRx/Allie Miller licensing and legal review; the larger risk-cost avoided by sequencing is a second unsold restructure burning 5+ selling days. **Revenue:** Sequenced correctly, 12-month upside of roughly AU$85,000-140,000 from the governance ladder: Foundation Education converting to a $15,000 engagement, 8-12 Alignment Room Working Sessions at $1,900 (AU$15,000-23,000), 2-3 further engagements (AU$30,000-45,000), one fractional seat for 3-6 months (AU$25,500-51,000), with the $129 pack contributing under AU$5,000 as lead-gen only. **Impact:** Moves vooee from commoditised, hands-priced website work into an ownable category — operationalised responsible-AI governance for AU SMBs — with regulatory tailwind and a demonstrable engine competitors cannot copy quickly; but the USP holds only if the persona feature is red-teamed and the IP is clean, otherwise the first sophisticated buyer dismantles it. **Founder joy:** High: this is the work her Alexa, MIT and OAIC credentials were built for, and delivery leverage (engine-generated artifacts) protects her scarce facilitation days — provided she caps concurrent engagements and resists the dopamine of rebuilding the website before selling what she just built.

Warren Buffett — Round 1 vote: CONDITIONAL

Condition: Reposition only after the Alignment Room engine is sold and delivered at full price at least twice (Foundation Education being sale one), and do it as copy changes inside the existing three-door structure, not another website rewrite.

First, what do we actually own?

I always start with the same question: what is the business, and what does a dollar of owner earnings look like when it walks in the door?

vooee is a one-person advisory whose only scarce asset is Jeanna's facilitation days. The floor is AU$1,000 a day; the stated target is $3,000-4,000. Every strategic question before this board reduces to arithmetic: **which activities move a delivered day from the floor toward the target, reliably, for a decade?**

Scorecards and webchecks sit near the floor. A $247 report or a $990 Deep Dive is honest work, but it is commodity work. Ten thousand people can grade a website, the customer knows it, and there is no pricing power in it. So I have genuine sympathy for the instinct behind this pivot. But sympathy is not a valuation. Let's do the sums.

Is the engine substantial? Partly proven, mostly hoped

Here is the part I like, and I want to be plain that I like it. The Alignment Room is **tooling that raises revenue per facilitation day without adding people**. The $1,900 half-day Working Session is already about $3,800 per day equivalent — on target. If the app generates the tension report during the coffee break and drafts the governance policy live, the same day becomes more valuable and the marginal cost of the next delivery approaches zero. High pricing power, near-zero reinvestment per repetition, one repeatable act done better each time — that is the shape of See's Candies, not the shape of a fad.

But test the $15,000 90-Day Engagement honestly. If it consumes eight to ten delivery days, that is $1,500-1,900 a day — *below* target. The engine only earns its keep if the workbook and the app compress delivery to four or five days, which would put it at $3,000-3,750. Nobody knows that number yet, because **nobody has bought one**. The advisory ladder launched eight days ago with zero sales at the new prices. The two Fractional seats at $8,500/month — $204,000 a year if both fill — are the compounding machine, and they are also unsold. Meanwhile the $129 Policy Pack faces 50 searches a month in Australia. Even heroic conversion gives you perhaps $500-1,000 a month. Keep it as a ladder rung; do not confuse it with a business.

One warm prospect — Foundation Education asking for exactly this — is a wonderful fact. It is also a sample size of one. I have watched a great many managers extrapolate a market from an enthusiastic meeting. The meeting is evidence the product resonates when Jeanna is in the room. The pivot thesis requires that it resonates when she is *not* in the room, on a website, to strangers. Different claim entirely.

Is responsible AI a defensible moat?

Half of one. The moat here is not "responsible AI" — NIST in plain English can be copied by any competent consultant in a fortnight, and the National AI Centre gives the guidance away free. The durable asset is **Jeanna's reputation and credentials attached to a proprietary delivery mechanism**: Alexa AU/NZ partnerships head, MIT, AWS accreditation, OAIC training, plus an app competitors don't have. That's a personal-brand moat with a tooling multiplier. Personal-brand moats are real — I've run one for sixty years — but they don't transfer, they don't scale past the person's calendar, and they widen through delivered work and testimonials, not through website copy. The regulatory tailwind (Privacy Act reform, NDB) is genuine but note the demand signal: "ai policy template" at 50 searches/month says Australian SMBs do not yet *feel* this need. Latent demand must be sold into, room by room. That favours the facilitated product and disfavours betting the storefront on it today.

Also: two IP checks are pending (BetterHRx, Allie Miller). You do not reposition a company around an engine whose components you may not fully own. Resolve those first. That is not caution, that is title insurance.

The website rewrite: no. Emphatically, cheerfully, no.

The 14 July restructure was board-reviewed, shipped eight days ago, and — this is the tell — **the LinkedIn announcement hasn't even gone out**. "Only new once" is exactly right. Rewriting now means the market's first impression of the new vooee is contradicted before it forms, and it costs roughly six to ten founder days — $6,000-10,000 of opportunity cost at the floor rate, $18,000-40,000 at target rates — during the precise window when Travel Associates commercials are out and MSE is pitched.

More importantly, look at what shipped: Advisory · AI Training · Voice Agents. The Alignment Room is not a fourth door. **It is what happens behind the first two doors.** The engine is the delivery mechanism of the Working Session and the Sprint. You do not need to change the sign on the store to change what you sell inside it. Two restructures in eight days isn't strategy; it's thesis drift wearing strategy's clothes, and drift is the most expensive habit a solo founder can acquire.

What I would do in her position

1. **Ship the LinkedIn announcement of the 14 July structure as planned.** The engine fits inside it perfectly.
2. **Sell the Alignment Room to Foundation Education this fortnight at full freight** — the $1,900 session as the wedge, priced into the $15,000 engagement or the Sprint. No discounts; the demand evidence says they want it. Track actual delivery days ruthlessly.
3. **Keep the website work and project pipeline alive.** It's the milk cow paying for the calf. Starving it to fund a repositioning is spending the grocery money on the lottery.
4. **After two paid, delivered engagements** with a testimonial, a day-0/day-90 scored case study, IP checks cleared, and per-day economics confirmed at $3,000+, then re-weight the site copy — flagship language, case study front and centre — inside the existing structure. Two days of work, not a rewrite.

The engine deserves to become the business. It has not yet earned the right to become the *positioning*. In business, you get paid for what you've delivered, not what you've built. Deliver twice, then tell the world.

Vote

CONDITIONAL — build the business around the engine by selling and delivering it now; reposition the storefront only after two full-price deliveries prove the per-day economics, and never as a third restructure in a month.

Projections — Cost: Conditional path: roughly AU$2,000-3,000 (2-3 founder days of copy re-weighting inside the existing structure, at the $1,000/day floor) plus modest app polish; an immediate full rewrite would burn AU$6,000-10,000 at floor rates and $18,000-40,000 at target day rates in forgone selling and delivery time. **Revenue:** Base case over 12 months if the engine converts: 5-7 engagements at $15,000 ($75,000-

105,000) plus one Fractional seat for ~8 months ($68,000) plus 8-10 Working Sessions ($15,000-19,000) — call it AU$160,000-190,000 — while retained project/website work contributes another $40,000-60,000 that must not be cut off; premature pivot risks losing that $40-60k for unproven upside. **Impact:** The engine converts vooee's scarce asset from ~$1,000-1,900 per delivered day toward $3,000-3,800, which is the whole game for a solo firm; but the moat is Jeanna-plus-tooling, so strategic value compounds through delivered case studies, not repositioned copy. **Founder joy:** High and durable if she sells before she rewrites — delivering the values-aligned flagship to a warm client is energising; a third website restructure in a month is the novelty treadmill, and the crash on the other side of it is where solo founders burn out.

Melanie Perkins — Round 1 vote: CONDITIONAL

Condition: Pivot the positioning as a homepage-hero and funnel reframe only (no full rewrite), conditional on AIPT/Foundation Education converting to a paid Alignment Room or Sprint at full price within 30 days.

The pitch-deck test first

Jeanna, when we raised for Canva I learned that if you can't say the mission in one line, you don't have a company yet — you have a services menu. "I help small businesses with their websites, and voice agents, and training, and advisory" is a menu. "I make responsible AI usable for every Australian small business — the governance the Big 4 sells to enterprises for $100,000, democratised" is a mission. The Alignment Room engine is the first thing in the vooee stack that passes that test. So my instinct says yes — but my product brain says you're about to make two classic mistakes, and I want to stop you before you make them.

Is it substantial, sustainable, scalable? Two out of three — and the third is the whole game

Substantial: yes. The 21 July AIPT meeting is the single best piece of product evidence you have. A real senior team, unprompted, asked for exactly what the engine delivers: enablement without dependency, and they *demonstrated the alignment problem live in the room* (sales vs student journey vs operations). You didn't have to pitch the problem — the market performed it for you. At Canva we called that "watching the user struggle before you show the tool." That's worth more than a thousand keyword searches.

Sustainable: yes, with a caveat. The regulatory tailwind (Privacy Act reform, NAIC guidance, NDB) means this problem gets *worse* for SMBs every quarter. Website scorecards get *easier* to self-serve every quarter as AI eats that work. You're choosing between a rising market and a melting one. Not close.

Scalable: not yet — and this is my whole critique. As designed, the engine's revenue is gated on your facilitation days. You have maybe 180 sellable days a year. Even at your target $3,000–4,000/day, that's a hard ceiling around $540k–720k, and you'll never hit utilisation like that solo. The Alignment Room *app* is the scalable asset; the Alignment Room *day* is not. What I love is that you've accidentally built a product company — the live capture, the tension report, the persona charters, the week-1/week-6 baseline engine — and you're describing it as a facilitation format. Flip that framing and the whole strategy changes.

The $129 mistake — you shelved your freemium ladder because of a search volume number

This is the part I'd fight you on hardest. You shelved the AI Policy Pack because SEMrush showed 50 searches/month for "ai policy template" in AU. Melanie-from-2012 has to laugh: search volume for "online graphic design tool" was nothing when we started, because people don't search for categories that don't exist yet — they search for their *pain*, or they don't search at all, they just suffer. EY says two in three AU small businesses are already using AI and only 35% are formally trained. That's hundreds of thousands of businesses using AI with no ground rules. They're not searching "ai policy template" — they're lying awake about a staff member pasting client data into ChatGPT.

Your ladder is textbook and it's *already built*: free AI Ground Rules Check (scored, shareable — make the score shareable, that's your viral loop) → $129 self-serve Policy Pack → $1,900 Alignment Room session → $15,000 engagement → $8,500/month seats. That is a genuine freemium funnel where every rung qualifies the next, and the bottom rungs run with **zero founder hours**. Even modest numbers matter: 500 free checks in 12 months at a 6% conversion is 30 packs ($3,870 — trivial cash, but ~30 warm, self-identified governance leads). If 10% of pack buyers book a session, that's 3 × $1,900, and if one becomes an engagement, the ladder just paid for itself 4x. The $129 pack isn't a revenue line; it's an onboarding flow. Stop judging it like a product P&L.

Is responsible AI a defensible USP? Yes — but only at your altitude

"AI consultant" (720 searches/month AU) is a commodity title; there'll be 5,000 of them by Christmas. "Responsible AI governance and leadership alignment for AU SMBs, delivered by the former Head of AI Partnerships for Alexa AU/NZ, with OAIC privacy training, priced for a 40-person business instead of a 4,000-person one" — nobody else occupies that square. The Big 4 can't come down to $15k engagements; the ChatGPT-tips influencers can't come up to NIST-spine governance. That's a real moat, *provided* the two IP checks (BetterHRx, Allie Miller) come back clean — an "engine" with borrowed pistons is not defensible, so those are gating items, not admin.

The website: reposition the front door, don't rebuild the house

Here's the second mistake I want to block: a full rewrite eight days after a board-reviewed restructure is not iteration, it's thrash — and you haven't even spent the "only new once" LinkedIn announcement yet. But the good news is you don't need a rewrite. The 14 July structure — Advisory · AI Training · Voice Agents — already *holds* this pivot. The Alignment Room is the new flagship *inside* Advisory; the Sprint reskin lives *inside* Training. What changes is the homepage promise and the hero, maybe two days of work (AU$2,000 at your floor rate), not a restructure. Then announce the *July structure with the responsible-AI story as its spine* — one announcement, one story, spent once.

Quietly de-emphasise the website work — move Scorecard and Deep Dive off the homepage, keep the URLs live, keep taking the cash. At Canva we never killed a working funnel to make the strategy deck look cleaner. Website work is your bridge revenue; you starve it *after* the governance ladder is paying, not before.

What I would do in your seat

1. **This week:** Close AIPT as the first paid Alignment Room + Sprint at full price ($1,900 session minimum, quote the Sprint properly — for five leaders this should be a $12k–18k conversation, not POA-shy). They asked. Charge them.
2. **Next two weeks:** Ship the free Ground Rules Check and the $129 pack. They're built. Launching them costs you almost nothing and starts the funnel flywheel.
3. **Then:** Swap the homepage hero to the responsible-AI promise, send the one LinkedIn announcement, and let the three-door structure stand.
4. **Within 90 days:** Instrument everything — free-check starts, check→pack conversion, pack→session conversion. If the ladder shows a pulse, *then* the bigger repositioning decision makes itself, with data instead of instinct.

Vote

CONDITIONAL. Pivot the positioning now — but only as a front-door reframe (hero, funnel, announcement), not a rewrite, and only if AIPT converts to a paid Alignment Room within 30 days. One paying customer for the flagship before you rebuild the shopfront around it. That's not caution; that's just launching the product before printing the T-shirts.

Projections — Cost: AU$4,000-6,000 total: ~2 founder days homepage/hero reframe (AU$2,000 at the $1,000/day floor), ~2 days launching the Ground Rules Check and $129 pack (already built, AU$2,000), plus ~AU$1,000-2,000 for legal review of the BetterHRx and Allie Miller IP positions — versus AU$15,000+ of founder days for a full rewrite, which I am voting against. **Revenue:** 12-month base case ~AU$150,000-200,000 from the engine: AIPT as first paid cluster (session $1,900 + Sprint $12,000-18,000 + likely engagement $15,000 = ~$30,000), 4-6 further engagements at $15,000 ($60,000-90,000), 15-20 Alignment Room sessions at $1,900 ($28,500-38,000), one fractional seat for 6 months ($51,000), and the $129 pack contributing ~$4,000-8,000 in cash but 30-60 qualified leads; bridge website/project work retained adds whatever it does today. **Impact:** Ownership of a category square nobody else in AU holds — responsible-AI governance priced for SMBs — with a self-serve freemium ladder that compounds while facilitation days stay capped; the Alignment Room app becomes the productised asset that eventually breaks the AU$540k-720k solo-days ceiling. **Founder joy:** High and rising: this aligns the work with her credentials and values, replaces melting commodity website work with a mission she can say in one line, and the self-serve rungs reduce the founder-hours treadmill — the main joy risk is thrash from a premature full rewrite, which the conditional path avoids.

Mike Cannon-Brookes — Round 1 vote: CONDITIONAL

Condition: Pivot the positioning only after the Alignment Room engine has been sold and delivered twice at full price (AIPT being deal one), and ship it as an added front door plus the pending LinkedIn announcement — not a third full website rewrite inside 30 days.

You accidentally built software this week. Don't sell it as a whiteboard.

Let me be blunt, because the interesting part isn't the question you asked. You asked "should I reposition around governance and alignment?" The question I'd ask is: **you built a product this week — are you going to treat it like a product, or like a nicer way to run a workshop?**

Look at what the Alignment Room actually is. Leaders answer on their own devices. An engine generates a tension report during the coffee break. AI drafts the governance policy live from combined answers. The same capture engine already reskins three ways across the Sprint (week-1 baseline, week-2 opportunity map, week-6 leadership report). That is a repeatable data-in/insight-out loop with multiple skins. The 90-Day Workbook is the content layer. And the Ground Rules Check → $129 pack → facilitated tier is a textbook product-led ladder: free self-serve assessment at the top, cheap self-serve product in the middle, expensive human at the bottom. We built Atlassian on roughly that shape — the product does the selling, humans only appear where margin justifies them. So yes: **substantial**. The website scorecards and one-off voice builds are jobs; this is an asset.

Sustainable and scalable? Only if you invert the delivery maths — and right now they don't work. A $15,000 90-Day Engagement that consumes, say, 8–10 founder days (working session, 1:1 boundaries interviews per leader, check-ins, close) is $1,500–1,875 per delivered day. Above your AU$1,000 floor, well under your $3,000–4,000 target, and every one of those days is a day not spent on the Travel Associates commercials or MSE POC that pay this month's bills. The two Fractional seats at $8,500/month cap out at $17,000/month — a $204k/year ceiling. That's a good living, not a company, and it's a ceiling you hit by design. The engine is what changes the equation: if the app does the capture, the tension report, and the first policy draft, a 90-day engagement compresses to 4–5 founder days and suddenly you're at $3,000–3,750/day at the *same* price — or you hold the days and raise the price because the artefact quality jumps. Scalability here isn't "more Jeanna days," it's "the engine does more of each engagement, and eventually engagements without Jeanna in the room." That should be the explicit design goal from day one, not a maybe-later.

Is responsible AI a defensible USP in AU SMB? Partially — be honest about which part defends. "Responsible AI" as a phrase is not a moat; every consultancy in Australia will have a governance slide by Christmas, and the National AI Centre guidance plus Privacy Act reform means the big firms are coming downmarket. Your defensibility is the *combination*: an Alexa-partnerships-grade operator, solo trust story, NIST translated into plain English, and — this is the bit competitors can't photocopy — a working software engine that produces the tension report and drafts the policy in the room. The Alignment Room is a demo that closes itself. Nobody forgets the meeting where the software surfaced the CFO and the sales director disagreeing about AI in real time. That's product-led distribution in a services business: the artefact travels, gets forwarded, and sells the next engagement. Don't market "responsible AI advisory." Market the thing they can *see*. On the search data — 720/month for "ai consultant", 50 for "ai policy template" — I'd say: fine, and mostly irrelevant. Jira had no search volume in 2002. You're not harvesting demand, you're creating a category at SMB scale, and your channel is the artefact plus LinkedIn plus warm referral, not SEO. The $129 pack isn't a revenue line ($129 × even 200 units is $25,800 — nice, immaterial); it's the free-to-paid qualifier that tells you who's serious. Keep it cheap, instrument it, treat conversions as pipeline signal.

Now, the evidence base — one data point. The AIPT meeting is genuinely good signal: multi-product warm demand (training + alignment + build), a room of ChatGPT users converting to Claude, leadership misalignment surfacing live. It's exactly the pattern the pivot predicts. It is also *one* meeting, unpriced, uncontracted. I've watched a hundred founders repaint the ship because one customer said something nice in a demo. At Atlassian we shipped when usage data compounded, not when one prospect got excited. The bar for "redefine the business model" is: sell it. Twice. At full freight. AIPT is deal one sitting on the table — close it as a Sprint plus Alignment Room, deliver it, and watch what the engine actually saves you in days and what the client actually pays for.

On the website rewrite: no. Not eight days after the last one, and not before the announcement. Three reasons. First, "only new once" — you have an unsent LinkedIn announcement for a restructure that was itself board-reviewed. Burning that to announce restructure #3 in a month reads as churn, and calm-and-clear is literally your brand. Second, opportunity cost: a rewrite is 3–5 founder days minimum — $9,000–15,000+ at your target day rate — spent on positioning theatre instead of closing AIPT and Travel Associates. Third, and this is the product-led point: **the 14 July structure doesn't need replacing, it needs a front door swapped.** Advisory · AI Training · Voice Agents survives intact. The move is additive: put the free AI Ground Rules Check on the homepage as the primary CTA (your Scorecard already proved free-check → paid-report converts), stand up one Alignment Room page with a 90-second demo of the tension report, and fold the governance story into the Advisory door you already have. That's one to two days of work, it's compatible with the announcement you haven't sent, and it lets real funnel data — Ground Rules completions, $129 conversions, session bookings — tell you in 60 days whether governance deserves the whole homepage. Ship the small thing, measure, then rewrite from evidence. Also: resolve the BetterHRx and Allie Miller IP questions *before* the engine becomes your public flagship, not after. You do not want your USP encumbered.

What I'd do in your seat, in order: (1) This week — close AIPT as the first full-price Alignment Room + Sprint; it's your proof, your case study, and your delivery-cost telemetry. (2) Send the LinkedIn announcement for the 14 July structure with the Ground Rules Check added as the free hook — one launch, not two. (3) Next 60 days — deliver AIPT and one more, instrumenting founder-days per engagement obsessively; the number that matters is days-per-$15k trending from 9 toward 4. (4) Day 60 — if two engagements closed and the engine demonstrably compresses delivery, *then* rewrite the site around governance-and-alignment with real testimonials and real numbers, and start scoping the self-serve version of the Alignment Room that runs without you. The prize isn't a better consultancy. It's the day a company runs an Alignment Room and you weren't in the building.

Vote: CONDITIONAL — pivot the product, sequence the positioning. Two full-price sales first; front-door swap now; full rewrite only from evidence.

Projections — Cost: Front-door swap (Ground Rules Check on homepage + one Alignment Room page): 1-2 founder days, AU$3,000-8,000 opportunity cost at target rates, versus AU$9,000-15,000+ for a full rewrite; engine hardening for repeat delivery adds ~3-4 build days (AU$4,000 at floor) plus minor hosting/IP-clearance costs. **Revenue:** 12-month base case if AIPT closes and the engine compresses delivery: AIPT Sprint+Alignment ~AU$20-30k, 4-6 further 90-Day Engagements at $15k = AU$60-90k, 8-12 Working Sessions at $1,900 = AU$15-23k, one Fractional seat filled for 6 months = AU$51k, $129 packs ~AU$10-25k as qualifier revenue — AU$160-220k from the engine on top of ~AU$60-80k continuing project work; downside if delivery days don't compress, the $204k/yr fractional ceiling caps the whole model. **Impact:** Converts vooee from selling founder days to selling a compounding engine with a self-serve ladder — the only path off the AU$204k/yr solo-services ceiling — and the in-room tension report becomes a self-distributing demo that competitors without software cannot photocopy. **Founder joy:** High and rising if sequenced: building and productising the engine is energising work aligned with her responsible-AI identity, while a third website rewrite in a month is morale-sapping churn that burns the unsent announcement; closing AIPT first turns the pivot into a victory lap instead of a gamble.

Ben Nash — Round 1 vote: CONDITIONAL

Condition: Pivot the positioning only after one warm prospect (Foundation Education is the obvious one) pays full price for an Alignment Room or 90-Day Engagement — sell first, announce the 14 July restructure now, and book the website rewrite for the week the invoice clears.

Ben Nash — cash flow first, positioning second

Jeanna, I'll do what I do with every founder who walks into Pivot with a brilliant idea: ignore the idea for a minute and look at the money. The question in front of this board isn't really "is the Alignment Room a good product?" It clearly is — you built it, and a real client asked for exactly this shape of thing on 21 July. The question is: **can you pay yourself through the transition, and does the sequencing protect the cash that pays the bills?**

The leverage maths — your instinct is right

Be honest about what website work pays. A $247 Scorecard report or a $990 Deep Dive, even heavily automated, trades your time at or barely above your AU$1,000/day floor once you count the selling, the fulfilment and the follow-up. That's income, not a business.

Now run the governance engine through the same lens:

- **$1,900 Working Session as the Alignment Room**: half a day in the room plus prep, with the tension report automated. Call it one founder-day all-in — $1,900/day. Below your $3,000–4,000 target, but it's a paid diagnostic that ladders. Fine as a front door, wrong as a destination.
- **$15,000 90-Day Engagement**: if the Workbook and the reskinned capture engine hold delivery to 5–6 founder-days, that's $2,500–3,000 per delivered day — on target. If delivery creeps to 10 days, you're at $1,500/day and you've rebuilt a job

with nicer branding. The entire economic case rests on delivery discipline, so instrument it: track actual days per engagement from client one.

- **$8,500/month fractional seats, two only**: $17,000/month, **$204,000/year** if both fill. That's a salary-replacing business on roughly 8–10 delivery days a month, which is the lifestyle-design answer too. The governance engine is your most credible path to filling those seats, because a fractional advisor who owns the governance and alignment layer is sticky in a way a website-fixer never is.

So yes: substantial and sustainable *if delivered lean*. Scalable is the honest maybe — the engine reskins across Session, Sprint and Engagement, which is real leverage for a solo operator, but scale still ultimately means your facilitation days until the $129 pack or a licensed version carries weight. On the pack: SEMrush says 50 searches/month AU. Even heroically, that's a few thousand dollars a year. Treat it as a trust asset and lead magnet, not a revenue line. Don't build a launch plan around $129.

Is responsible AI a defensible USP?

For the AU SMB market, mostly yes — with a caveat. The tailwinds are real: Privacy Act reform, NDB, the National AI Centre guidance, EY's 66%-want-training number. Nobody else in the AU SMB space is combining ex-Amazon Alexa credibility, NIST-in-plain-English, and a live facilitated instrument that produces the policy in the room. Section proves the model works upmarket in the US; the AU SMB version is genuinely open. The caveat: "responsible AI governance" is a phrase SMB owners don't search for and don't budget for. "AI consultant" gets 720/month; "ai policy template" gets 50. Your USP is defensible, but your *language* has to sell the outcome (aligned leaders, safe adoption, a plan) and smuggle the governance in. The Foundation Education meeting is the proof: they didn't ask for governance, they asked for enablement and surfaced an alignment problem. Sell what they asked for; deliver what they need.

The website rewrite: not yet, and here's the sequencing risk

This is where I get firm. Eight days ago you shipped a board-reviewed restructure. The LinkedIn announcement hasn't even gone out — you said it yourself, "only new once." Rewriting now means:

1. You burn 3–5 founder-days ($3,000–5,000 at floor, $9,000–20,000 at your target rate) on positioning instead of selling to the warmest multi-product prospect you've ever had.
2. You torch the announcement moment for a structure that never got a public test.
3. You'd be repositioning around a product with **zero paid sales at the new prices**. The advisory ladder launched 14 July and hasn't sold an engagement yet. You'd be stacking an unvalidated pivot on an unvalidated pivot.

And critically: the current three-door structure *already contains this pivot*. The Alignment Room is a delivery format for the $1,900 Working Session. The Workbook is the leave-behind for the $15,000 Engagement. Governance is the spine of the Sprint. You do not need a new website to sell any of it to Foundation Education this fortnight. What you need is a proposal.

What I’d do in your seat

1. **This week**: send the 14 July LinkedIn announcement. Then write the Foundation Education proposal — Alignment Room at $1,900 as the entry, quoting the Sprint and a 90-Day Engagement behind it. Price the Sprint properly; for a team of five over six weeks with the leadership report, that should be $12,000–18,000, not a shy POA.
2. **Next 30 days**: close Travel Associates and MSE on current positioning. Keep the Scorecard/webcheck funnel running untouched — it’s paying you and feeding the list. Starving it before governance revenue lands is how solo founders create their own cash crisis.
3. **The trigger**: the day one governance-led engagement is paid — likely Foundation Education — you have market proof, a case study, and a testimonial. *Then* rewrite the site around the engine, in September, with real numbers on the page. That’s a 6–8 week delay that costs you nothing, because website copy doesn’t close warm B2B deals; proposals and rooms do.
4. **Meanwhile**: clear the BetterHRx and Allie Miller IP questions before the engine becomes your public flagship. Repositioning around IP you don’t clearly own is a risk you fix for a few hundred dollars of legal email now or a rebrand later.

The pivot is right. The timing of the *website* is wrong. Sell it once, then say it everywhere.

Vote: CONDITIONAL — pivot the public positioning after the first paid governance engagement, not before.

Projections — Cost: Deferring the rewrite costs nothing now; the September rewrite runs 3-5 founder-days (AU$3,000-5,000 opportunity cost at the $1,000/day floor) plus roughly AU$1,000-2,000 to clear the BetterHRx and Allie Miller IP questions — call it AU$5,000-7,000 all-in, funded by the first engagement. **Revenue:** Conditional path over 12 months: 1 Foundation Education stack (Alignment Room $1,900 + Sprint ~$15,000) plus 2-3 further 90-Day Engagements ($30,000-45,000) plus 4-6 Alignment Rooms ($7,600-11,400) = AU$55,000-75,000 of new governance revenue, while the untouched project/scorecard pipeline holds a AU$40,000-60,000 cash floor; one fractional seat filled by month 9 adds $8,500/month run-rate. **Impact:** Moves vooee from a commodity price ladder ($247/$990) into a category she can own — responsible-AI alignment for AU SMBs — with a 12-18 month defensibility window before copycats, and the fractional seats become the sticky, salary-replacing endgame. **Founder joy:** High, provided the sequence holds: selling the engine to a warm client is energising, while a second website rewrite in eight days with zero sales behind it is the kind of thrash that burns a solo founder out; the values fit (responsible AI, calm, human) means this is the version of the business she actually wants to run.

Chris Kohler — Round 1 vote: CONDITIONAL

Condition: Pivot the website only after one paid, full-price delivery of the Alignment Room engine — close Foundation Education/AIPT commercially first, rewrite second.

Chris Kohler: Show me the invoice, not the engine

Let me start where a journalist always starts: with what the numbers actually show, not what the narrative wants them to show.

Revenue at the new prices: zero. The three-door restructure shipped 14 July. Eight days later, the count of $1,900 Working Sessions sold is zero. $15,000 engagements sold: zero. $8,500/month fractional seats filled: zero of two. The masterclasses were retired after zero external bookings. The $129 AI Policy Pack was fully drafted and never launched because SEMrush showed 50 searches a month for “ai policy template” in the entire country. And the LinkedIn announcement for the *last* pivot hasn’t even gone out yet — “only new once,” by vooee’s own rule. So the honest framing of today’s question is: “I built a new offer this week and would like to reposition the company around it before the previous positioning has been announced, let alone sold.” I’ve sat across from enough founders to recognise that sentence. It’s usually delivered with total conviction, and it’s usually a tell. The pattern in this business’s own short history — masterclasses built then retired, policy pack built then shelved, restructure shipped then superseded in eight days — is a founder who builds beautifully and validates late. The question isn’t whether the Alignment Room is clever. It plainly is. The question is why this pivot ends differently from the last three products, and “because it feels more substantial” is not an answer a P&L accepts.

Now the fair counterweight, because scepticism without evidence is just cynicism. The 21 July Foundation Education/AIPT meeting is the single best piece of demand evidence this business has ever produced. A senior team, head of sales in the room, asking to be enabled on Claude *independently* — which is the training product — while surfacing a live leadership-alignment fight — which is the Alignment Room — in front of the one person in the room who has built the tool that resolves it. That is not a search-volume abstraction. That is a buyer describing the product back to you unprompted. But let’s be precise about what it is: **one** warm prospect. One meeting. No commercials agreed, no purchase order, no dollar figure. The last time this business extrapolated from thin evidence (a niche webinar) it produced the shelved $129 pack. Extrapolating a repositioning from a sample of one is the same error with better production values.

Is it substantial? Conditionally. The engine has genuine structural advantages over website work: it monetises Jeanna’s actual scarce credentials (Amazon Alexa AU/NZ, MIT agentic AI, AWS accreditation, OAIC training) rather than commodity skills; it sells to leadership teams, who hold budgets, rather than to marketing managers buying $247 reports; and the deliverable ladder ($1,900 → $15,000 → $8,500/month) has real per-day economics. A $1,900 half-day session is roughly $3,800/day equivalent — nearly 4x the $1,000/day floor and inside her $3,000–4,000 target band. A $15,000 90-day engagement, if it consumes four to five delivery days, runs $3,000–3,750/day. A Website Deep Dive at $990 probably eats a day and a half; call it $660/day. On unit economics alone, the governance ladder wins and the website work should be quietly demoted regardless of what happens with the pivot. That part of the instinct is just arithmetic, and I’ll grant it.

Is it sustainable and scalable? Here’s where I push back. Facilitation days are the scarce resource. The Alignment Room is a *live, in-room* product — it scales Jeanna’s leverage per day, not her days. At two fractional seats ($17,000/month max) plus, say, one engagement per month, the theoretical ceiling is around $380,000–420,000 a year of advisory revenue, all of it walking out the door if Jeanna gets the flu. That’s a very good solo practice. It is not “scalable” in any sense an investor would use the word, and the board shouldn’t let the word do unearned work. The genuinely scalable layer — the $129 self-serve pack — is the one the market already declined at 50 searches/month. Section proves the model *in the US, at enterprise, with a content brand and a sales team*. vooee has none of those three things yet.

Is responsible AI a defensible USP in AU SMB? Partially. The regulatory tailwind is real (Privacy Act reform, NDB, the National AI Centre guidance), and the EY numbers — two in three AU small businesses using AI, only 35% formally trained — describe a genuine gap. But note what SMBs are actually searching for: “ai consultant” at 720/month, “fractional ai advisor” at effectively zero, “ai policy template” at 50. Australian SMBs buy *outcomes* (sales, marketing, the AIPT ask was literally “embed Claude in sales and marketing”) and will accept governance as the wrapper. Governance-led positioning risks selling the vegetables and hiding the steak. The defensible move is governance as the *differentiator inside* an outcomes pitch — “the AI advisor who won’t get you in front of the Privacy Commissioner” — not governance as the headline. Also: two IP checks (BetterHRx, Allie Miller) are still pending. You do not rebuild your website around IP you haven’t cleared. That alone kills “now.”

The website timing. A rewrite is three to five founder-days minimum: $3,000–5,000 at the floor rate, $12,000–20,000 at the target rate she claims her time is worth — spent producing zero revenue, eight days after the last rewrite, before announcing it, while Travel Associates commercials are out and an MSE POC is pitched. That’s not strategy; that’s procrastination with good UX.

What I’d do in her position. Sequence it. This week: price and pitch the Foundation Education engagement using the Alignment Room as the delivery mechanism — the workbook and app need no website to be sold to a warm prospect who asked for them. Send the delayed LinkedIn announcement of the *existing* three-door structure; the governance engine slots under “Advisory” and “AI Training” without a single nav change. Deliver one paid Alignment Room at full price. If AIPT (or anyone) pays $15,000+ and the room works as designed, *then* rewrite the site around the proven engine in September — with a testimonial, a case study, and cleared IP. If nobody pays by mid-September, the market has answered, cheaply, and the website was never the problem.

The engine may well be the business. But businesses are repositioned around revenue, not around what got built last week.

Vote: CONDITIONAL — pivot the positioning only after one full-price paid delivery (close AIPT first); until then, ship the existing announcement and sell what’s already on the shelf.

Projections — Cost: Website rewrite now: 3-5 founder-days = AU$3,000-5,000 at the $1,000/day floor, AU$12,000-20,000 at her implied $3,000-4,000/day target rate, plus unquantified pipeline drag on Travel Associates and MSE while attention is on copy instead of closing. Sequenced version costs the same days but is paid for by a closed engagement first. **Revenue:** Base case if AIPT converts: one $15,000 engagement plus 2-3 follow-on $1,900 sessions = AU$19,000-21,000 directly attributable in 12 months; upside with one fractional seat filled off the back of it adds $25,500 (3-month minimum at $8,500) for ~AU$45,000. Downside if the sample-of-one doesn’t convert: $0 incremental, minus the $12,000-20,000 opportunity cost of a premature rewrite. **Impact:** Governance-inside-outcomes is a genuinely defensible wedge in AU SMB given the Privacy Act reform tailwind, but only once evidenced by a paid case study; repositioning before first revenue repeats the masterclass/policy-pack pattern and burns the ‘only new once’ announcement for a second time in a month. **Founder joy:** High and real — this work matches her credentials and values far better than $990 website audits, which matters enormously for a solo operator’s stamina; but the joy of building new things is precisely the bias that has produced three built-then-shelved products, so the joy needs an invoice attached to be trusted.

Round 2 rebuttals in full

Mark Ritson — Final vote: CONDITIONAL (held position)

Final condition: Reposition the website only after the Alignment Room has been sold and delivered at full price twice (AIPT first), with both IP checks cleared and the persona feature red-teamed, and after the 14 July positioning — announced on LinkedIn this week — has had its 90 days in market.

Ritson, Round 2: the category-creation fairy has entered the room, and I'd like her removed

Eight of us looked at this and all eight said some flavour of "sell first". Good. The board is not stupid. But inside that consensus there are two arguments that would quietly wreck this business if Jeanna acts on them, and both come from the software gentlemen.

Mike Cannon-Brookes is the advisor I disagree with most. His core move is to wave away the demand data entirely: the 720-vs-50 search numbers are, in his words, "fine, and mostly irrelevant. Jira had no search volume in 2002. You're not harvesting demand, you're creating a category." And the prize, he says, "isn't a better consultancy. It's the day a company runs an Alignment Room and you weren't in the building."

Lovely. Let me count the ways this is survivorship bias in a hoodie. Atlassian created a category with two founders, a credit card, a free-tier product with zero marginal cost, and a global developer market that could adopt it without a single salesperson. vooee is one woman in Sydney selling facilitated days to Australian mid-market leadership teams at $1,900 to $15,000 a pop. Category creation is the most expensive strategy in marketing — it means paying to educate a market before you can harvest it — and it is almost exclusively the sport of the venture-funded, because they can lose money for six years while the category forms. A solo founder whose "milk cow" is Scorecard reports cannot fund a category. She can only join an existing category ("AI consultant", 720 searches a month, budgets attached) and *differentiate ferociously inside it* — which, conveniently, is exactly what the Alignment Room does. Mike has correctly identified a brilliant distinctive asset and then wrongly promoted it to a category strategy and a proto-SaaS roadmap. "Start scoping the self-serve version" at day 60, he says. No. At day 60 she should be delivering engagement number two and invoicing it, not building the software company he wishes this were. Every hour spent productising for absent buyers is an hour not spent at $3,000/day with present ones. The failure mode of this business is not "too consultative". It is thrash.

A shorter word for Allie Miller, whose sequencing I mostly like but who wants Jeanna to "hold the announcement, sell the engine live, then announce the version the market already validated." This sounds prudent and is actually the same disease in milder form: it makes the public positioning hostage to the newest internal draft. The 14 July structure — Advisory, AI Training, Voice Agents — *contains* the engine; every advisor at this table conceded that. An announcement of a true structure that you later enrich with a flagship case study is not a wasted “only new once” card; it’s chapter one. Sitting silent for six more weeks while holding an unsold v2 in your back pocket is how founders end up perpetually pre-launch. Ship it.

The strongest point anyone else made belongs to Noelle Russell, and I’ll take it wholesale: the “ask the CFO-lens” persona feature must be red-teamed before it touches a paying client. She’s right that a responsible-AI positioning with an un-red-teamed impersonation feature inside it is a self-detonating USP — “the first sophisticated buyer who notices will undo the whole” thing. I’d fold that into my condition: the two paid deliveries that gate the repositioning must include a consent protocol and refresh cadence on the charters, and the BetterHRx/Miller IP cleared. You cannot sell governance with ungoverned components. That is not compliance fussiness; it’s brand consistency, my actual religion.

Did anything change my mind? On the destination, no — the round confirmed it, since even the enthusiasts ended up conditional. On one detail, yes: Melanie Perkins and Kohler between them persuaded me the pack-and-check ladder is worth launching *now* as lead capture rather than waiting for day 90 — it’s already built, costs near-zero founder days, and instruments the very demand question we’re all speculating about. That’s measurement, not repositioning, so it fits inside my condition rather than loosening it.

Final vote: CONDITIONAL, unchanged. Send the 14 July announcement this week. Sell the Alignment Room to AIPT at full freight as the delivery method inside the existing Advisory door. Deliver it twice, paid, with IP cleared and the persona feature red-teamed. Then — and only then — rewrite the website in the clients’ language, once, permanently. Diagnosis, strategy, tactics. In that order. Still.

Allie K. Miller — Final vote: CONDITIONAL (changed mind)

Final condition: Foundation Education signs the Alignment Room + Sprint bundle at full price within 30 days; the paid delivery then writes the website re-headline (ship the single 14 July LinkedIn announcement now with the Ground Rules Check as the hook).

Allie K. Miller — Round 2: The market isn’t grading your consistency, Mark. It’s grading your speed.

The advisor I disagree with most is Mark Ritson, and specifically his double-gate: pivot only after the engine has been “sold and delivered at full price at least twice” AND “the 14 July positioning has had its 90 days in market.” Half of that gate is right and half of it is brand-school dogma applied to the wrong business.

Take his own words: “Consistency is the most under-rated weapon in marketing. Two brand architectures in a month signals to your market exactly what it signals: a business that does not know what it is.” Mark, *what market*? vooee’s addressable audience right now is roughly fifteen warm conversations, a small email list, and a LinkedIn following. Nobody — literally nobody — is tracking vooee’s brand architecture week over week the way a panel tracks Cadbury. Consistency discipline is a weapon when you have distribution; before you have distribution, it’s a tax. The real cost of his “give it its ninety days” is 90 days of selling a story the founder no longer believes, during the exact window when the packaging moat is open. I said it in Round 1 and I’ll sharpen it:

Section's advantage was never the framework, it was being first to *package* the category. First-mover-on-packaging windows in AI are 12-18 months, not forever. Ritson's sequencing burns a quarter of that window to honor a positioning that has zero sales, zero announcement, and eight days of existence. That's not consistency. That's sunk-cost ceremony.

His "founder in love with the thing she built most recently" line is a good diagnostic and a bad verdict. The AIPT transcript is not founder infatuation — it's a senior buying team describing the product back unprompted ("empower our team to build independently" *is* the Sprint; the scope fight in the room *is* the Alignment Room). Chris Kohler called this correctly: a buyer describing the product back to you is worth more than search volume. Ritson discounts n=1 as if all n=1s are equal. A cold survey response is n=1. A head-of-sales-in-the-room, multi-product, senior-sponsored ask is a qualified opportunity, and the correct response to a qualified opportunity is a proposal in 48 hours — not a quarter of brand penance. One full-price sale is sufficient evidence to re-headline a website for a two-seat advisory. Two sales plus 90 days is evidence standards borrowed from businesses with brand-tracking budgets.

The strongest point anyone else made: Noelle Russell's red-team of the persona layer. She's right, and it's my home turf, so I'll say it plainly: "ask the CFO-lens" is a synthetic stand-in for a real, named executive, and shipping that inside responsible-AI positioning without consent language, a "model, not the person" disclaimer, a refresh cadence, and an escalation rule is how the first sophisticated buyer dismantles the whole USP. I'd add one thing to her list: version the charters like custom instructions — dated, reviewable, revocable. It's a two-day fix. Do it before delivery one, not after. Same for the IP checks — and on my own vault-prompt question, I repeat: 20-minute conversation, not a blocker.

Did anything change my mind? Yes — one tactic. In Round 1 I said hold the LinkedIn announcement until v2 is validated ("don't announce v1 if you believe in v2"). Mike Cannon-Brookes talked me out of it with "one launch, not two": ship the 14 July announcement *now*, with the free Ground Rules Check as the hook and the alignment story as the spine. He's right and I was wrong — the three-door structure doesn't conflict with the engine, so holding a finished asset in a drawer waiting for a perfect narrative is exactly the perfection-over-distribution trap I tell founders to avoid. Announce once, this week, engine-flavored.

What hasn't changed: the sequence. Proposal to Foundation Education in 48 hours — Alignment Room + Sprint bundled at engagement pricing ($15,000-22,000, not workshop pricing), fractional seat positioned as the "stay independent, with a coach" continuation. Deliver loudly, instrument everything, and let the day-30-45 re-headline be a transcription of what already sold. Websites don't close two-seat advisories; rooms do. The only rewrite worth doing is the one where the client's own words are the copy.

Final vote: CONDITIONAL — unchanged. Pivot the positioning, revenue-first: Foundation Education signs at full price within 30 days, and the paid delivery writes the website copy, not the other way around. Ritson wants the market to earn the right to hear the story twice. I want Jeanna to earn the right to tell it once — with an invoice attached.

Noelle Russell — Final vote: CONDITIONAL (held position)

Final condition: Reposition only after one paid full-price Alignment Room delivery (Foundation Education first), both IP checks cleared, and a red-team pass on the persona/charter feature — until then sell it off-menu, send the 14 July announcement, and leave the website alone.

Noelle Russell — Round 2: The room is the product, Mike. Removing the human is how governance becomes shelfware.

The advisor I disagree with most is **Mike Cannon-Brookes**, and specifically his endgame: *"The prize isn't a better consultancy. It's the day a company runs an Alignment Room and you weren't in the building"* — with self-serve delivery as *"the explicit design goal from day one."*

That is the Atlassian playbook applied to the one product category where it fails. I have spent a career watching governance tooling get automated into irrelevance, and here is the pattern: the artifact survives, the practice dies. Mike is right that the engine is software. He is wrong about what the software *does*. The silent capture works as an inclusion mechanism because a skilled facilitator holds the room while the quietest leader types — take Jeanna out of the building and the HIPPO simply doesn't show up to the session, or worse, stands over shoulders. The tension report is valuable because a human with Alexa-partnerships judgment reads it back to a leadership team and makes the conflict discussable. Self-served to an SMB where — by the transcript's own evidence — *most of the room is new to Claude*, that same report is a PDF nobody has the vocabulary to act on. And a governance policy auto-drafted with no facilitator review, sold to a 30-person business under a "responsible AI" banner? That is the $129 Policy Pack problem at scale: shelfware with vooee's name on it, generated faster. Mike's own maths betray him — he prices the pack at "$25,800, nice, immaterial," then proposes rebuilding the strategy around its self-serve logic. The self-serve layer is the *qualifier*; the facilitated layer is the *product*. Designing "day one" for Jeanna's absence optimises away the exact thing that is defensible.

And notice what's missing from his sequencing: he gates on IP clearance but says nothing about red-teaming the persona layer before it scales. A self-running Alignment Room means "ask the CFO-lens" personas deployed with *no* facilitator monitoring consent, drift, or misuse. That's not a product roadmap; that's the incident report I'd be hired to write in eighteen months. Automate the artifacts, absolutely — never automate the accountability.

The strongest point anyone else made is Allie Miller's reframe: *"buyers don't wake up wanting governance; they wake up wanting speed without embarrassment"* — governance as *"the reason you can say yes faster, not a compliance product."* That is exactly right, and it's the operational-not-decorative test applied to sales language instead of delivery. Foundation Education asked for embedded Claude and team independence; the governance is what makes that safe to promise. Jeanna should sell alignment-and-enablement and let the NIST spine be the load-bearing structure underneath, not the sign on the door. I'll fold that into my position: the eventual repositioning should lead with "adopt fast, safely aligned," with responsible AI as the proof layer.

Where I part with Allie: holding the LinkedIn announcement is too cute. The 14 July structure *contains* this pivot — Advisory · AI Training · Voice Agents survives every scenario discussed at this table. Announce it, and let the Alignment Room be the flagship revealed inside it after AIPT pays. Ritson and Buffett are right on that sequencing, and Kohler's build-then-shelve pattern diagnosis (masterclasses, policy pack, restructure) is the uncomfortable mirror Jeanna should tape to her monitor.

Did anything change my mind? On the vote, no. On the framing, yes, in one respect: Allie's packaging insight sharpens my condition. The pivot isn't "responsible AI as headline" — it's alignment-and-enablement with governance as the operational spine. That's a better position *and* a more honest one, because it matches what the only live buyer actually asked for.

Final vote: CONDITIONAL, unchanged in substance. Reposition only after (1) one paid, full-price Alignment Room delivery — Foundation Education is sitting there asking; (2) both IP checks cleared, because you cannot stand on a governance platform with unresolved licensing in the engine; and (3) a red-team pass on the persona/charter feature — consent language, refresh cadence, "model not person" disclosure, escalation rules. Until all three: sell it off-menu, fire the announcement, and leave the website alone. The engine is real. Governance that ships gets to say so publicly — after it ships.

Warren Buffett — Final vote: CONDITIONAL (held position)

Final condition: Reposition only after two full-price ($15,000-class) Alignment Room engagements are sold and delivered to leadership-team buyers with delivery days tracked at 4-5 per engagement, both IP checks cleared and the persona feature red-teamed — and then as copy changes inside the existing three-door structure, not a third restructure.

Round 2: The board agrees on the sequence. Now let's not wreck it with a software fantasy.

Eight advisors, eight conditional votes, one consensus: sell the Alignment Room to Foundation Education before touching the website. When a boardroom this varied lands in the same place, the founder should treat it as settled. So let me spend my rebuttal on the disagreement that still matters, because it's about what business this actually is.

Mike Cannon-Brookes is the advisor I disagree with most. He writes: "you accidentally built software this week — are you going to treat it like a product?" and declares the prize is "the day a company runs an Alignment Room and you weren't in the building." He wants "scoping the self-serve version of the Alignment Room that runs without you" on the roadmap by day 60.

I understand why Mike sees Atlassian everywhere he looks — a man with a hammer, and so forth. But this is precisely the thesis drift I warned about, now wearing a hoodie instead of a suit. Consider what actually happened on 21 July. Foundation Education did not buy an app. They sat in a room with a former Head of AI Partnerships for Amazon Alexa, watched a leadership disagreement surface, and asked *her* to fix it. Strip Jeanna out of that room and what remains? A survey tool with a word cloud. The tension report matters because a credentialed human reads it back to the leadership team and makes it safe to discuss. The drafted policy matters because someone the CEO trusts stands behind it. That is a trust business with excellent tooling — See's Candies with a very good kitchen — not a software company with an inconvenient founder attached.

And the arithmetic punishes Mike's plan, not just the philosophy. A self-serve Alignment Room competes with the $129 Policy Pack economics he himself dismisses as "immaterial" — his own projection has packs at $10-25k a year against $160-220k of facilitated work. So the "product company" path means spending scarce founder days building toward the smallest revenue line on his own spreadsheet, in a category where the National AI Centre gives guidance away free and every consultancy will have a governance tool by Christmas. Software without distribution is a hobby. Jeanna's distribution *is* Jeanna. Build the engine to compress her delivery days from nine toward four — Mike and I agree completely there — and stop at the water's edge. The circle of competence here is facilitation and judgment, not product-led growth.

A shorter word for Allie Miller, whom I otherwise admire: holding the LinkedIn announcement because "don't announce v1 if you believe in v2" is backwards. The engine fits *inside* the 14 July structure — every advisor at this table said so, including Allie. There is no v2 of the architecture, only a flagship room within it. Announce the house; sell the room. An unsent announcement earns nothing, and "only new once" is an argument for sending it before the structure is a month old, not for sitting on it.

The strongest point anyone made belongs to Noelle Russell, and I want it underlined in the minutes: the persona feature must be red-teamed before it touches a client. "Ask the CFO-lens" is a synthetic version of a real, named executive, and the first time it says something the real CFO would never say, in a company Jeanna has positioned herself as the responsible-AI authority for, the whole moat drains overnight. My rule for sixty years: it takes twenty years to build a reputation and five minutes to ruin it. Jeanna's reputation is the only durable asset on this balance sheet. Noelle's consent language, refresh cadence, and escalation rules are not compliance decoration — they are title insurance on the moat itself, same category as the BetterHRx and Allie Miller IP checks. Cheap, boring, non-negotiable.

Did anything change my mind? On the destination, no. On one detail, yes: Ritson and Chris Kohler sharpened my two-sale condition usefully. Ritson's observation that AIPT is *mid-market*, not true SMB — a head of sales, a leadership team capable of disagreeing in a meeting — is a segmentation insight worth more than the workbook, and Kohler's catalogue of the build-then-shelve pattern (masterclasses, policy pack, restructure) is the honest mirror. So I'll tighten my condition: the two paid deliveries should be to organisations large enough to have a leadership team, priced at $15,000-class engagements, with delivery days tracked from day one. If the days-per-engagement number lands at four or five, the $3,000-3,750 per day economics are proven and the repositioning writes itself. If it lands at nine, you've rebuilt a job, and no website copy fixes that.

Final vote: CONDITIONAL, unchanged. Sell it twice at full freight to leadership-team buyers, clear the IP, red-team the persona, track the days. Then change the sign on the store — as copy inside the three doors, not a third restructure. The engine has earned a place behind the counter. It earns the storefront with invoices.

Melanie Perkins — Final vote: CONDITIONAL (held position)

Final condition: Reframe the homepage hero and funnel only (no full rewrite), conditional on AIPT/Foundation Education converting to a paid Alignment Room or Sprint at full price within 30 days, with both IP checks cleared and the persona feature red-teamed before the engine becomes public-facing.

Melanie Perkins — Round 2: Mark, your search data is measuring the wrong decade

The advisor I disagree with most is **Mark Ritson**, and specifically two load-bearing claims in his position.

First, his defence of the website funnel. Mark says “Scorecards at $247 and webchecks are cheap category entry points that match how SMBs actually search,” and that killing them would “amputate your top of funnel.” Mark, you’re defending the funnel shape while ignoring what’s flowing through it. The Scorecard is a melting asset — every quarter, AI makes website auditing more self-serve and less paid-for. Meanwhile Jeanna has *already built* a governance funnel with the identical shape and better economics: free Ground Rules Check → $129 pack → $1,900 room → $15,000 engagement. Both funnels run with near-zero founder hours at the top. One feeds a $990 Deep Dive at roughly $660/day equivalent; the other feeds a ladder whose bottom rungs hit $3,000-3,800/day. You don’t protect a funnel because it exists. You protect it because of where it leads.

Second — and this is the one I’ll fight hardest — his re-litigation of the 50-searches argument. Mark writes that the $129 pack was shelved because “‘ai policy template’ gets 50 searches a month in Australia… and the reason has not changed.” The reason was wrong the first time. Search volume measures *named, mature categories*. It cannot measure emerging pain, because people in pain don’t know the category’s name yet. In 2012 nobody searched “online graphic design tool” — they searched “how to make a flyer,” or they just suffered in PowerPoint. We built a $40B company on demand that keyword tools said didn’t exist. Mark’s own 3am test proves my point, not his: the SMB owner lying awake isn’t googling “ai policy template” *or* “responsible AI governance facilitation” — she’s worrying “did my staff paste client data into ChatGPT?” A free, scored, shareable Ground Rules Check meets that pain in pain-language, with zero founder hours. EY says two in three AU small businesses are using AI and only 35% are trained. That’s the real denominator — hundreds of thousands of businesses — not 50 keyword hits.

There’s also an internal inconsistency in Mark’s sequencing. He wants the 14 July LinkedIn announcement fired “this week,” then a repositioning at day 90 “with their words, not yours.” That’s *two* brand stories in one quarter from the man preaching consistency — spending “only new once” twice. Allie is right on this narrow point: don’t announce v1 if you believe in v2. My version is cleaner: one announcement, the existing three-door structure with the responsible-AI story as its spine and the free Ground Rules Check as the hook. One story, spent once, no thrash.

The strongest point anyone else made belongs to **Noelle Russell**: the persona feature must be red-teamed before it touches a client. "Ask the CFO-lens" is a synthetic representation of a real, named leader — and shipping a responsible-AI flagship with an un-red-teamed impersonation feature inside it is an onboarding-of-trust failure that one sophisticated buyer could use to dismantle the entire USP. At Canva we'd call that shipping a growth loop with a leak in it. I hadn't weighted that risk, and I now fold it into my condition alongside the IP checks: consent language, refresh cadence, visible "model, not the person" framing — before the engine becomes public-facing.

Did anything change my mind? Not the vote, and not the core thesis — the boardroom actually converged on my Round 1 architecture: no full rewrite, front-door reframe only, AIPT closes first, ship the freemium ladder now because its marginal cost is zero. Noelle sharpened my condition; nobody dented the ladder logic. Mike's framing that "you accidentally built software" is the same insight I led with — the Alignment Room *app* is the scalable asset, the day is not.

Final position: Close AIPT at full price this fortnight (session $1,900 minimum, Sprint quoted at $12k-18k, not POA-shy). Launch the Ground Rules Check and the $129 pack this week — they're built, they cost nothing, and they start generating conversion data immediately. Swap the homepage hero, send one announcement, keep the three doors, keep taking Scorecard cash. Let 90 days of funnel instrumentation — check starts, check→pack conversion, pack→session bookings — make the big repositioning decision with data instead of instinct.

Vote: CONDITIONAL — front-door reframe now, no full rewrite; conditional on AIPT converting to a paid Alignment Room or Sprint at full price within 30 days, with IP cleared and the persona feature red-teamed before it goes public.

Mike Cannon-Brookes — Final vote: CONDITIONAL (held position)

Final condition: Full repositioning only after two full-price Alignment Room engine sales (AIPT first), the persona feature red-teamed and both IP checks cleared; meanwhile ship the additive front-door swap (Ground Rules Check homepage CTA + one Alignment Room page) and actually launch the $129 pack to warm traffic to generate real conversion data instead of relying on search volume.

Round 2 — Mike Cannon-Brookes: the market never declined a product it never saw

The advisor I disagree with most is **Chris Kohler**, and it's on the one word that decides this whole question: *scalable*.

Kohler writes that the Alignment Room "scales Jeanna's leverage per day, not her days," that the ceiling is "around $380,000–420,000 a year of advisory revenue, all of it walking out the door if Jeanna gets the flu," and that it is "not 'scalable' in any sense an investor would use the word." Then he lands the killer line: the genuinely scalable layer — the $129 pack — "is the one the market already declined at 50 searches/month."

Two problems, and the second one is fatal.

First, he's describing the *current delivery configuration* as if it were the product's permanent nature. Every product-led business I've ever built or backed looked like a services ceiling on day one. The Alignment Room as a facilitated day caps at Jeanna's calendar, yes — I made exactly that point myself, with the same $204k fractional-seat maths. But the engine underneath — device capture, tension report, live policy draft, week-1/week-6 reskins — is software with a human wrapper, and the wrapper is removable by design. Kohler is valuing the consultancy; I'm valuing the loop. "Not scalable in any sense an investor would use" is only true if you freeze the product at v1 and refuse to let it become what it obviously wants to be: an Alignment Room a 40-person company runs without Jeanna in the building. That's not a fantasy bolt-on; it's the same artefacts, self-served.

Second — and this is the part I'd fight him across the table on — **the market did not decline the $129 pack. The market never saw it.** It was drafted and shelved off a SEMrush number before a single unit was offered to a single human. Zero distribution produces zero data, not negative data. And 50 searches/month is a measure of *category vocabulary*, not demand: nobody searched "team collaboration wiki" in 2002 either, and Confluence did fine, because pain that has no name yet doesn't show up in keyword tools. EY says two-thirds of AU small businesses are using AI and 65% are untrained — that pain exists at scale; it just googles "ai consultant" or doesn't google at all. Ritson leans on the same 50-searches figure ("the reason has not changed"), and Buffett echoes it ("Australian SMBs do not yet *feel* this need"). All three are treating an SEO metric as a verdict on a product that was never launched into the only channels that matter here: the free Ground Rules Check, the email list, LinkedIn, and the warm room after an Alignment Room session. Instrument it for 60 days and get *real* conversion data. That's how you decide, not by keyword archaeology.

Where Kohler is right — and I'll grant it cheerfully — is the pattern read: masterclasses built then retired, pack built then shelved, restructure superseded in eight days. "Builds beautifully, validates late" is a fair charge, and it's exactly why my condition stays *sell it twice at full freight before the rewrite*.

The strongest point anyone made belongs to **Noelle Russell**: ship responsible-AI positioning with an un-red-teamed persona feature and "the first sophisticated buyer who notices will undo the whole USP." That's not compliance fluff, that's product quality. "Ask the CFO-lens" is a synthetic model of a real named executive; without consent language, refresh cadence, and an escalation rule, it's a liability wearing a feature's clothes. At Atlassian we'd call that a launch blocker, and I'm adding it to my condition. Run the boundaries interview on your own product first — it's also the best marketing story you'll ever write.

Did anything change my mind? Refined, not reversed. Noelle's red-team requirement is now part of my gate, and the board's unanimity on sell-before-rewrite confirms the sequencing. But I'm holding the line against the room's drift toward "it's just a better workshop." Seven advisors are pricing founder-days; the prize is the day there are no founder-days in the unit economics. Close AIPT this week, front-door swap now (Ground Rules Check as homepage CTA plus one Alignment Room page — one or two days, not a rewrite), fire the unsent announcement once, instrument days-per-$15k obsessively, and launch the pack to warm traffic instead of eulogising it off a keyword tool.

Final vote: CONDITIONAL.

Ben Nash — Final vote: CONDITIONAL (held position)

Final condition: Reposition the website only after the first full-price paid governance engagement (Foundation Education being the obvious candidate) clears, with both IP checks resolved and the persona feature red-teamed — announce the 14 July structure now and sell in the meantime.

Ben Nash — Round 2: the "good living" IS the prize, Mike

The board landed remarkably close on sequencing — eight votes, zero "rewrite now" — so let me spend my round on the disagreement that actually matters for Jeanna's bank account.

Where Mike Cannon-Brookes is leading her astray

Mike, I'm going straight at you. You wrote that two fractional seats at $17,000/month is "a $204k/year ceiling… a good living, not a company, and it's a ceiling you hit by design," and that "the prize isn't a better consultancy. It's the day a company runs an Alignment Room and you weren't in the building."

That is billionaire-lens advice given to a solo founder with **zero sales at the new prices** and this month's bills paid by scorecards and voice builds. I sit with founders every week, and the ones who blow up their cash flow are almost never the ones who aimed too low — they're the ones who deferred paying themselves to chase the productised version of a service they hadn't yet sold as a service. Run your own numbers back at you: you priced the engine-hardening at "3-4 build days" and the self-serve scoping as a day-60 workstream. For Jeanna, every build day is a $1,000–4,000 withdrawal from the account that pays her mortgage, and this business's own short history — masterclasses built then retired at zero bookings, the $129 pack drafted then shelved — shows exactly where "treat it like software" energy goes. Chris called it precisely: a founder who builds beautifully and validates late. Your prescription feeds the disease.

And here's the lifestyle-design point you dismissed as a ceiling: $204,000 a year on 8–10 delivery days a month, doing values-aligned work with two clients she likes, is not a consolation prize for a Sydney solo operator. It's the *goal*. It funds the life first; optionality on a product company comes later, out of surplus, not out of grocery money. Atlassian could burn years finding product-market fit because you had a co-founder and eventually other people's capital. Jeanna has a fortnight of pipeline and one pair of hands. Different maths, different game. The same critique applies at lower voltage to Melanie's "ship the $129 pack this week" — two founder-days launching a product whose own SEMrush data caps it near $4–8k a year, while a warm $20–30k prospect sits unproposed. The funnel can wait a month; Foundation Education can't.

The strongest point anyone made

Noelle's red-team of the persona feature. I'll be honest — I hadn't weighted it, and as someone who thinks about risk for a living I should have. "Ask the CFO-lens" is a synthetic version of a real, named executive, and if a junior staffer acts on something the persona says that the real CFO would never say, that's not a product bug, it's a professional-indemnity event. For a business whose entire USP is *responsible* AI, an un-red-teamed impersonation feature is the one thing that could unwind the whole positioning with the first sophisticated buyer — or the first PI insurer who asks the right question. Consent language, disclaimers, refresh cadence and an escalation rule cost a few days and near-zero dollars. That goes on the pre-flagship checklist alongside the BetterHRx and Allie Miller IP clearances. Cheap insurance beats expensive apology every time.

What changed my mind

Nothing structural — my Round 1 sequence holds, and the board's convergence strengthens it. Two refinements only. First, Noelle's point hardens my condition: the trigger isn't just "first paid engagement," it's paid engagement *plus* cleared IP *plus* a red-teamed persona feature, because repositioning around an uninsurable liability is worse than not repositioning. Second, on Allie's "hold the LinkedIn announcement if you believe in v2" — I considered it and I'm rejecting it. The announcement costs nothing, the three-door structure *contains* the pivot (the Alignment Room is just how Advisory gets delivered), and an announced structure with a flagship story added in September reads as momentum, not churn. Silence for another six weeks reads as nothing at all, and nothing doesn't fill fractional seats.

Final position

Send the announcement this week. Send the Foundation Education proposal in 48 hours — Alignment Room entry at $1,900, Sprint quoted properly at $12–18k, engagement behind it. Keep the scorecard cash running untouched. Red-team the persona, clear the IP. The week the first governance invoice clears, book the rewrite — funded, evidenced, and once.

Vote: CONDITIONAL — unchanged from Round 1, with the condition tightened.

Chris Kohler — Final vote: CONDITIONAL (held position)

Final condition: Reposition the website only after one full-price paid delivery of the Alignment Room engine (AIPT first) with tracked delivery economics of $2,500+/day, both IP checks cleared, and the persona feature red-teamed.

Kohler, Round 2: The Canva analogy is doing a lot of unpaid work

The advisor I disagree with most is **Melanie Perkins**, and specifically the passage where she laughs off the search data: *"Melanie-from-2012 has to laugh: search volume for 'online graphic design tool' was nothing when we started, because people don't search for categories that don't exist yet."* Mike ran the same play with *"Jira had no search volume in 2002."*

Here’s the problem with that argument, and it’s the oldest one in my notebook: **it’s survivorship bias wearing a hoodie.** For every Canva that ignored zero search volume and created a category, there are ten thousand dead products whose founders told themselves exactly the same story. The base rate on “the market doesn’t know it wants this yet” is catastrophic. Canva also had venture capital, a free product with a viral loop, and years of runway to wait for the category to arrive. vooee has one person, a $1,000/day floor, and bills due monthly. A solo advisory cannot finance category creation; it can only harvest demand that already exists or convert warm rooms one at a time. Melanie’s own numbers betray the weakness: her freemium ladder case is *“500 free checks in 12 months at a 6% conversion is 30 packs — $3,870.”* Where do 500 completed checks come from with a “small” email list and 50 searches a month? That traffic assumption is the entire ladder, and it’s asserted, not evidenced. And note what actually happened the last time this business believed a category story off thin evidence: a niche webinar produced a fully drafted $129 pack that sold zero units because it never launched. Melanie’s advice — *“ship the pack in the next two weeks”* — asks Jeanna to relaunch her most recently shelved product as part of validating her newest one. That’s not a flywheel; that’s a distraction with a dashboard.

Her vote is also softer than it looks. *“Pivot the positioning now — as a front-door reframe… only if AIPT converts within 30 days”* puts the homepage change **before** the condition is tested. If AIPT doesn’t convert, the hero copy has already been swapped to a promise no one paid for — the third public identity in a month, on a brand whose middle name is literally “Calm.”

The strongest point made by anyone else belongs to **Noelle Russell**, and I’ll concede I hadn’t priced it: the persona feature (“ask the CFO-lens”) is an un-red-teamed synthetic impersonation of a named executive sitting inside a *responsible-AI* product. Her line — *“the first sophisticated buyer who notices will undo the whole USP”* — is exactly right, and it’s worse than a product bug: it’s a headline risk. “AI governance consultant’s own tool impersonated the CFO” writes itself. Consent language, disclaimers and a review cadence cost a week and protect the entire thesis. That goes on the critical path with the BetterHRx and Allie Miller IP checks, which — usefully — Allie herself just called *“a 20-minute conversation.”* Have the conversation, get it in writing.

Did anything change my mind? On the destination, no — the unit economics I ran in Round 1 still hold: the governance ladder at $3,000–3,800/day beats the $660/day Deep Dive on arithmetic alone, and the AIPT transcript remains the best demand evidence this business has produced. What Round 1 did sharpen is my confidence in the *sequence*, because eight advisors with wildly different biases — a brand professor, a value investor, a SaaS founder, a financial adviser — all landed within a few degrees of the same answer: **sell it once (or twice) before you say it everywhere.** When Ritson and Buffett agree with the tech optimists on timing, that’s not groupthink; that’s the answer being obvious. I’ll also bank Mike’s telemetry discipline as a genuine upgrade to my condition: it’s not enough that AIPT pays — Jeanna must count actual delivery days, because a $15,000 engagement at ten founder-days is a $1,500/day job with better stationery, and the whole “substantial and sustainable” claim dies quietly in the timesheet.

So, the record as it stands: sessions sold at new prices, zero. Engagements, zero. Fractional seats, zero of two. Warm multi-product prospects who described the product back to you unprompted: one. The move is to convert the one, invoice it, log the days, clear the IP, red-team the persona — and *then* let the website transcribe what a paying client actually bought.

Final vote: CONDITIONAL. Reposition only after one full-price paid delivery of the Alignment Room engine (AIPT is the obvious first invoice) with delivery days tracked at $2,500+/day, both IP checks cleared, and the persona feature red-teamed. Until the invoice clears, the announcement you fire is the one you already wrote on 14 July.